in the original key of A flat, and consequently to be regarded as the close of the exposition.

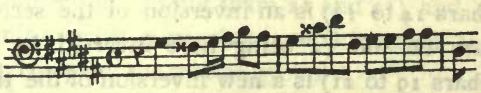
Middle Section.—After the first episode the subject appears (bar 13) in the alto in F minor; at bar 17 in the tenor in B flat minor, answered by the alto. In bar 21 there is the only approach to stretto which the fugue contains, two incomplete entries of the answer being introduced at half a bar's distance. In bars 23 and 24 an altered form of the subject appears in alto and treble, the leap of a minor 7th being substituted for a 6th.

Final Section.—The final group (bars 27 to 31) is irregular in key, only the bass and alto being in the tonic key, and the alto (answer) in one of the modified forms, ending on the tonic; the tenor modulates into C minor, and the treble into D flat. The coda begins in bar 31, and contains one isolated entry of the subject, in bars 33 to 34.

FUGUE 18

G SHARP MINOR (FOUR VOICES).

Exposition.—The subject is announced in the tenor:—



It will be observed that it makes a modulation into the dominant key, and a **tonal** answer will be required in order to return to the tonic. But as the new key is entered by the striking interval of he augmented fourth, which must be preserved in the answer, there is no alternative but to make the tonal change after the initial

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 42-43.
BWV 863. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan

dominant, thus touching transitionally on the key of the sub-dominant. As in many tonal fugues, a real answer is used later (see bar 37).

There is no codetta in the exposition, the voices following at regular distances of time—tenor, alto, treble, bass. There is a regular countersubject accompanying the entire subject.

Counter-Exposition.—There is comparatively little variety of key in the entries in this fugue. Those in bars 11, 15, 17 and 19 though not fulfilling all the conditions of a regular counter-exposition, are all in G sharp minor or D sharp minor, and on this account may be regarded as constituting an irregular one.

Middle Section.—The middle section properly begins with the episode in bar 21, for in bar 24 we get the subject modulating into the unrelated key of A sharp minor, and in bar 26 the answer in the key of B.

Final Section.—The final section begins at bar 32, with the subject in the tenor in the original keys, accompanied by the countersubject in the alto, and answered, after three bars of episode, by the treble, commencing in C sharp minor and returning to G sharp minor, the alto giving a few notes only of the countersubject. At the entries in bars 17, 24 and 26 the countersubject is absent.

There are five episodes (bars 9 to 11, 13 to 15, 21 to 24, 28 to 32, 34 to 37), of which the third is constructed of new material, used again, however, in a modified form for the commencement of the fourth episode (bars 28, 29). The rest, together with the end of episode 4, are founded on the last six notes of the subject. The employment of homophony, that is, of chords proceeding note against note in place of combined melodies, is remarkable in the first episode, being extremely rare in fugal writing.